Rafael Gil Diaz

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Backend-leaning full stack engineer with 3 years of experience shipping customer-facing products and developer tooling in Python and TypeScript. Skilled in AI and comfortable leading teams from discovery to delivery.

Experience

Founding Engineer — New York, NY
AchillesHR — *November 2025 – Present*

- Designed, shipped, and scaled our internal advertising platform, responsible for handling thousands of dollars of ad spend each month for our customers. Includes one-click ad creative using **Google Gemini 3 Pro Image** and the **Anthropic API**, and budget management across several platforms via their APIs (e.g. **Meta Ads**).
- Owned discovery and development of several net-new product features, including a full job board hosting service and an integrated analytics dashboard (among many others), directly contributing to the company's $1M+ in ARR growth over the past year.
- Designed and implemented our generalized event-based architecture, responsible for routing tens of thousands of events daily and used by every critical service on the platform.
- Diagnosed persistent memory issues on our API server, including a memory leak. Built out monitoring infrastructure while migrating observability from New Relic-specific tooling to **OpenTelemetry**.
- Improved our **Python**-based AI voice screening agent by implementing silence detection, upgrading to Cartesia Sonic-3 TTS, and fixing incoming call flows.

Software Engineer — Dallas, TX
PMG Worldwide — *June 2023 – October 2025*

- Led an engineering team in the complete redesign of our team's legacy sitelink ad management app, reducing asset upload times by over 70% and unlocking platform-agnostic updates through the **Google Ads** and **Microsoft Ads** APIs.
- Architected the **AWS** infrastructure for a Slack-integrated, **RAG**-powered chatbot, delivering context-aware answers to 10+ channel advertising teams and supporting dozens of concurrent users.
- Built a search query reporting tool in **Python** and **AWS** that started as a side project for one team before growing into management-required tooling across 80+ client teams in the search channel.
- Diagnosed performance bottlenecks in a legacy **Go** API. Constructed comprehensive documentation via **OpenAPI** and **Redocly**, enabling a faster onboarding process for new engineering hires.
- Implemented ad templating features across the **Django** backend and **React** frontend of a dynamic social ad tool generating over $1M in revenue and 30%+ ROAS improvement for clients.

Systems and Operations Intern — Urbana, IL
Information Trust Institute, University of Illinois — *June 2022 – May 2023*

- Developed an internal **Python** utility to sync Active Directory data to a self-hosted GitLab instance, ensuring proper repository access for 50+ users, deployed on-premises with **Docker**.
- Configured and maintained a network of 15+ **Ubuntu** systems for the Liberty Eclipse project (Dept. of Energy), and managed it remotely with **Ansible**, **Grafana**, and **Loki**.

Skills

Languages: Python, TypeScript, Go, SQL, SuperCollider
Frameworks: React, Node.js, NestJS, Django
Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, Docker, CI/CD, Linux, OpenTelemetry, Ansible
AI: Claude Code, RAG, Prompt Engineering

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Urbana, IL
B.S. in Information Science, B.A. in Music Technology — *May 2023*

3.68 GPA · Dean's List · Graduated with Honors